



Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacts with *Business Today* Editors at his office in 7, Lok Kalyan Marg, New Delhi

“Developed countries and developing countries will come together for the first time and find solutions to global problems. We have laid the foundation for inclusivity by inviting the African Union”

Q: With extreme weather events and the need to fight climate change turning into an urgent global issue, what is the progress you are hoping to achieve in the G20?

A: Humans have to accept that we are at the root of this problem. Yes, there are some nuances—there are those who are more responsible for the current situation than others. But we need to accept the reality of human impact on the planet. The day we accept it fully, the issue will not appear as a challenge or a problem. We will automatically look at solutions, be it through technology, be it through lifestyle, etc.

Today, there is a restrictive attitude in the world surrounding this issue. There is talk of limitations and there is an environment of criticism on climate actions. Hence there is friction among the countries regarding climate action. If all energy is spent on focussing only on what not to do rather than on what needs to be done, such an approach cannot lead to action.

Further, a divided world cannot fight a common challenge. That is why our approach during our G20 presidency and otherwise has been on unifying the world on this issue for what can be done.

The poor and the planet, both need to be helped. India is moving ahead on this with not only a positive attitude but also a mindset of driving solutions. Our initiative of ‘One World, One Sun, One Grid’ was a similar positive initiative.

There is a need to be action-oriented in thinking. If there is no transfer of technology, how can poor countries work on climate change mitigation? If there is inadequate climate finance, can poor countries work on climate change mitigation?

Our presidency prioritises resource mobilisation for climate finance, tailoring support for transitions to individual country needs. Acknowledging the need for innovative green technologies, we emphasise financial solutions, policies, and incentives to spur private investment in the development and deployment of low-carbon solutions.